

VIP C2 PROGRAMME — FULL STACK DEVELOPMENT WITH
MERN

Empathy Map Canvas

ShopEZ — MERN Stack E-commerce Application

Phase: Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

Document Version: 1.1

Date: 18th of june, 2026

Prepared by: V S S S Manikanta

Classification: Project Documentation — For Academic Submission

Empathy Map Canvas

1. Introduction

This document presents the **Empathy Map Canvas** for the two primary user personas of the ShopEZ platform. Empathy mapping is a collaborative design-thinking tool used to articulate a deep understanding of the target users' mental models, motivations, pain points, and desired gains — ensuring that design and development decisions remain grounded in genuine user needs rather than assumptions.

Two distinct personas have been profiled: the *Convenience-Seeking Shopper* (B2C end-consumer) and the *Operationally-Stretched Store Administrator* (B2B operator). Each persona is analysed across six dimensions: Think & Feel, Hear, See, Say & Do, Pains, and Gains.

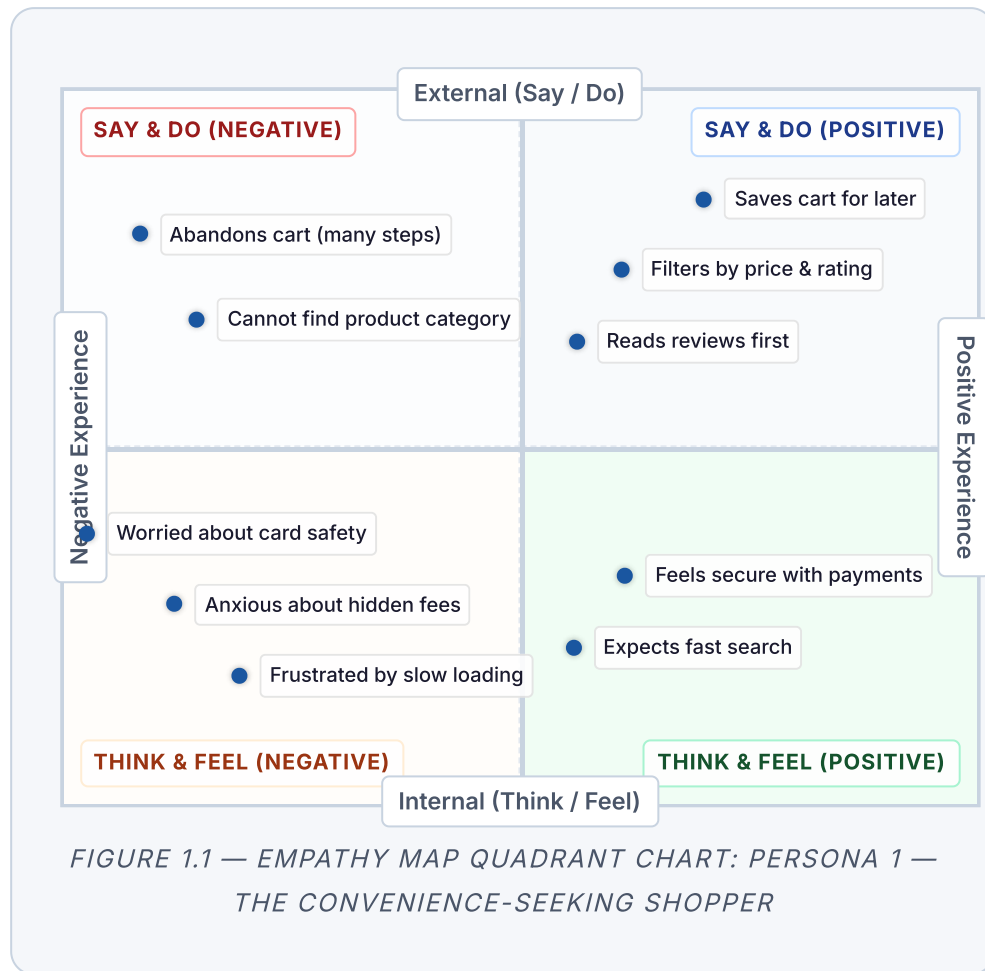
2. Persona 1 — "The Convenience-Seeking Shopper"

PERSONA 1

Name: The Convenience-Seeking Shopper

Profile: Urban professional, 24–40 years of age, technologically proficient. Shops online 3–6 times per month across devices (mobile and desktop). Values speed, security, and a frictionless purchasing experience above all else.

2.1 Empathy Map — Quadrant Chart



2.2 Detailed Dimension Analysis

💡 THINK & FEEL

- *"I hope this website is genuinely secure with my credit card information."*
- *"I need to find what I'm looking for within the first two minutes — otherwise, I'm leaving."*
- Experiences anxiety regarding undisclosed shipping fees at the final checkout step.
- Feels relief and purchase confidence when product pages feature high-resolution images, verified reviews, and clear stock indicators.

💡 HEAR

- *"You should try this platform — it delivered within 48 hours and the return process was effortless."*
- *"Always check the reviews before committing to a purchase."*
- *"Is the payment integration secure? Did they verify with a gateway?"*
- Peer recommendations heavily influence first-time platform adoption decisions.

SEE

- Competitor platforms with cluttered, information-dense product listing pages.
- Retargeted advertisements across social media for previously-viewed items.
- Clean, modern, mobile-first interfaces on market-leading e-commerce platforms.
- Inconsistent typography and layout on less-polished competitor sites.

SAY & DO

- *"I'll add this to my cart and complete the purchase on my laptop later tonight."*
- *"I cannot locate the exact category I need — the navigation is confusing."*
- Frequently abandons checkout flow when it requires more than three steps.
- Habitually applies price and rating filters before browsing product listings.
- Reads a minimum of five reviews before purchasing above ₹500.

PAINS

- Significant loading delays on product listing and image-heavy pages.
- Loss of cart items upon session expiry or when switching between devices.
- Unnecessarily complicated return/refund and order-tracking procedures.
- Unexpected charges appearing at the final step of checkout.

GAINS

- Time saved through a streamlined, guided checkout (Address → Payment → Confirm).
- Peace of mind from a trusted, recognisable payment gateway integration.
- High satisfaction when the search and filter system surfaces exactly what is needed within seconds.

3. Persona 2 — "The Operationally-Stretched Store Administrator"

PERSONA 2

Name: The Operationally-Stretched Store Administrator

Profile: Small-to-medium business owner, 30–50 years of age, moderate technical proficiency. Manages day-to-day store operations including inventory, pricing, and customer order fulfilment. Time-constrained and seeking efficiency over advanced configuration.

3.1 Detailed Dimension Analysis

💡 THINK & FEEL

- *"I need to know, at a glance, how much revenue was generated this month versus last."*
- *"Updating product images takes far too long — I need a faster image upload process."*
- Feels overwhelmed when order status updates require navigating multiple disconnected screens.
- Concerned about stock accuracy — fears overselling when checkout and inventory are not synchronised in real-time.

💡 HEAR

- *"You need a dashboard that shows your numbers clearly — not buried in spreadsheets."*
- *"Customers are complaining that product images are low quality and take ages to load."*
- *"You should be able to add a product listing in under two minutes."*

SEE

- Competitors using integrated admin panels with real-time analytics widgets.
- Their own sales data trapped in manual, error-prone spreadsheet exports.
- E-commerce SaaS platforms with high monthly subscription costs.

SAY & DO

- *"Every time I upload a new product, I need to manually resize and host the images."*
- *"I have no way to see which products are underperforming."*
- Spends disproportionate time on repetitive admin tasks that should be automated.
- Delays fulfilling orders because the order list interface is difficult to parse.

PAINS

- No centralised dashboard presenting aggregated sales metrics and order statuses.
- Image management is a significant operational bottleneck without CDN support.
- Inability to quickly identify low-stock items before they go out of stock.

GAINS

- A dedicated, secure /admin panel with role-protected access.
- Cloudinary-powered image uploads that auto-optimize and serve via CDN.
- Sales analytics (monthly revenue charts, order volume trends) at a glance.
- One-click order status updates (Processing → Shipped → Delivered).

4. Persona Comparison Summary

Dimension	Persona 1 — B2C Shopper	Persona 2 — Store Administrator
Primary Goal	Find and purchase products quickly and securely	Manage inventory and monitor business performance efficiently
Core Pain	Cart loss, slow site, confusing checkout	No analytics dashboard, manual image handling
Core Gain	Streamlined checkout, trusted payment gateway	Cloudinary CDN, real-time sales metrics
Platform Feature Needed	Search & Filter, Persistent Cart, 3-step Checkout	Admin Panel, Cloudinary Upload, Revenue Charts
Tech Enabler	React SPA + MongoDB Cart + Stripe/Razorpay	Node.js Admin API + Cloudinary + MongoDB Aggregation

5. Conclusion

The empathy maps for both personas reveal a shared underlying theme: the demand for **speed, trust, and operational efficiency**. The B2C Shopper requires a fast, transparent, and secure purchasing experience. The Store Administrator requires a centralised, automated operations platform. Both sets of needs are systematically addressed by the ShopEZ feature set, as validated in the *Problem–Solution Fit* and *Requirement Analysis* documents. Every platform feature should be evaluated against its contribution to resolving at least one documented Pain or enabling at least one documented Gain for these two primary personas.

